

COMBINED STATUS REPORT · ISSUE 5

# SDI Intelligence Programme Status

The server ordered for 2 November · twenty-five packs in the wave · Sage X3 loads estimating this week

ISSUED 6 OCT 2026

SUPERSEDES 29 SEP 2026

OWNERS J. GRAY · Y. KUMAR · M. YAZIR

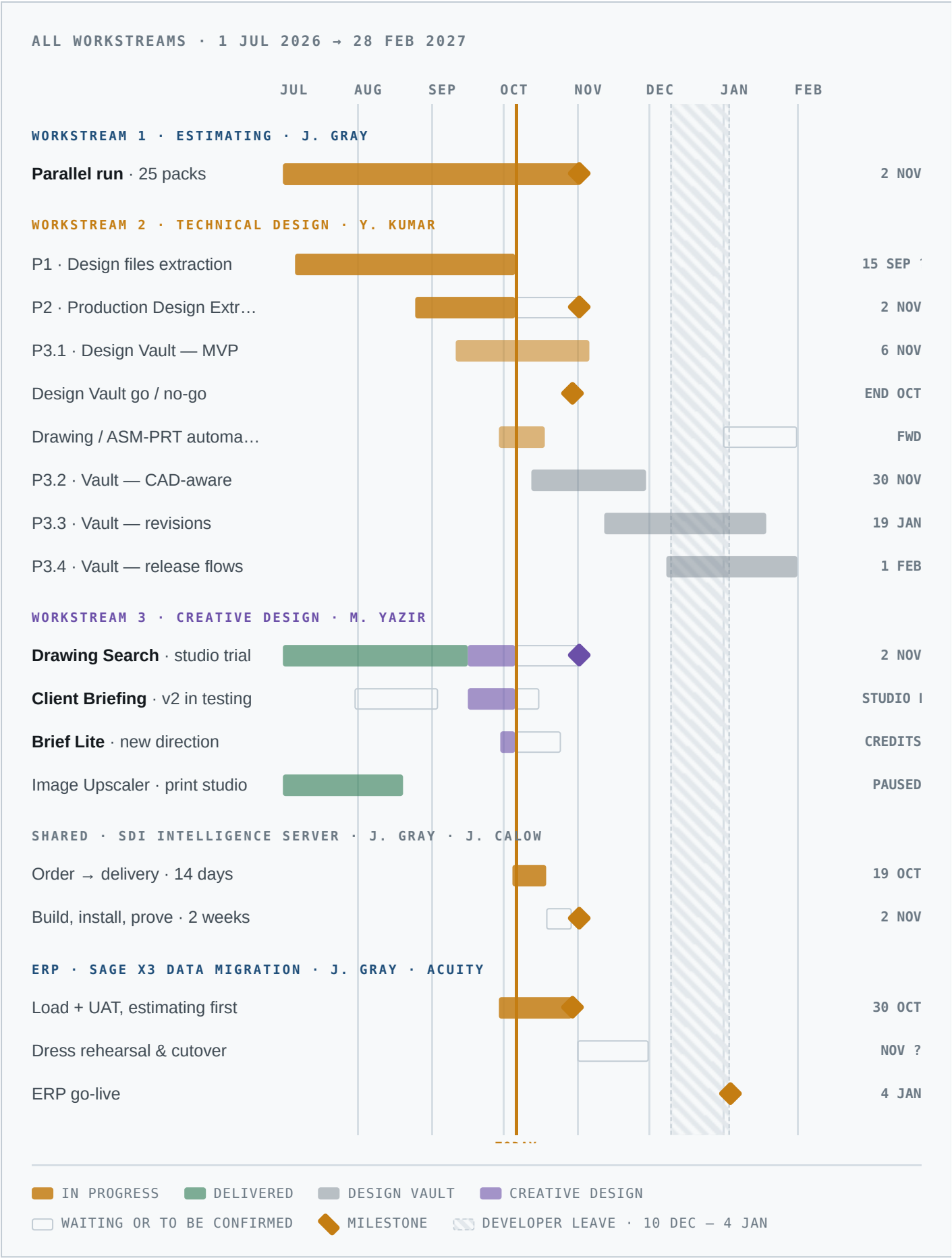
COMPILED BY J. GRAY

Status across **SDI Estimating Intelligence**, **SDI Technical Design Intelligence** and **SDI Creative Design Intelligence**, a week on from the fourth combined report, with the **Sage X3 data migration** and the **SDI Intelligence server** alongside them, and **a reply to each of Matt's four priorities of 30 September** in section 07. **The server is ordered:** a Scan 3XS Threadripper PRO build on a fourteen-day lead time, on site on 19 October, built by Jack Calow and James Gray, and **live for the estimators and the studio on Monday 2 November** with a week in hand — a few days later than the end of October promised last time. AI estimating, Production Design Extraction and Drawing Search go live on it together, confirmed by testing and sign-off rather than by the date. The estimating wave stands at **twenty-five packs and twelve reviews**; four more packs went out this week, each checked against a brief written from its drawings before the first run. Yogesh's **Design Vault now handles the hard cases** Ian asked to see proven. Muhammad's **Client Briefing tool was demonstrated to Matt**, tested with Jonathan on real briefs and is connected to WhatsApp; a lighter **Brief Lite** for account managers is the new direction from that meeting. **Sage X3 loads the estimating tables this week**, with customers and suppliers beside them.

| WORKSTREAM      | WHAT IT DELIVERS                                                                                             | OWNER              | NEXT DATE                                | STATE                                 |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 1 · ESTIMATING  | <b>SDI Estimating Intelligence</b><br>Drawings in; costed workbook, BOMs and Routes out                      | J. Gray            | 2 Nov 26 · with the server               | 25 OUT · 12 BACK                      |
| 2 · TECH DESIGN | <b>SDI Technical Design Intelligence</b><br>Document Manager tools, then the SDI Design Vault                | Y. Kumar           | 2 Nov · P2 live · Vault go/no-go end Oct | VAULT: HARD CASES PROVEN<br>UAT WAITS |
| 3 · CREATIVE    | <b>SDI Creative Design Intelligence</b><br>Drawing search on trial · Client Briefing in testing · Brief Lite | M. Yazir           | Studio demo w/c 12 Oct · live 2 Nov      | ON TRIAL IN TESTING                   |
| SHARED          | <b>SDI Intelligence server</b><br>Hosts all three · Threadripper PRO 9975WX · Scan 3XS                       | J. Gray · J. Calow | On site 19 Oct · live 2 Nov              | ORDERED                               |
| ERP             | <b>SDI Sage X3 Data Migration</b><br>Load and UAT together, area by area                                     | J. Gray · Acuity   | w/c 5 Oct · estimating loading           | TESTED BY 30 OCT                      |

## 01 The programme on one axis

Three workstreams, the server they share and the Sage X3 migration on one calendar. Re-drawn from Yogesh Kumar's tracker and status of 2 October, Muhammad Yazir's update of this week, the estimating test log of 5 October, the server build plan of 5 October and the Sage X3 plan.



## What moved since 29 September

**The server is ordered, and the go-live date is Monday 2 November.** Jack Calow and James Gray placed the order with Scan 3XS this week on a fourteen-day lead time. The machine is on site on Monday 19 October; Jack builds the host and its two virtual machines in the week of 19 October, James installs the services in the week of 26 October, known jobs are re-run against the laptop on 29 and 30 October, and it is live for the estimators and the studio on **2 November with a week in hand**. That is a few days later than the "end of October" in the last report, and it is a date with a plan behind it: section 05 carries the design, the build order, the costs beyond the hardware and the one decision still open with the supplier. AI estimating, Production Design Extraction and Drawing Search go live on it together.

**Matt set four priorities on 30 September:** the server's full installed cost and dates, review dates agreed with Dave, named owners and dates for the pricing gaps, and delivery focus on closing studio feedback and getting three services safely into use. Each is answered in section 07 with an owner and a date.

**The estimating wave is twenty-five packs and twelve reviews.** Four packs went out this week to Tim, Dave and Tony, and for the first time each was checked against a brief written from its drawings *before* the engine ran, so the book's faults were found in the engine and fixed there before anyone saw them. Seventy more numbered rules landed in the week, and the suite stands at 7,731 tests. Tim's and Dave's reviews of 30 September came back; Tim's on the lit header kit is the sixth AI-against-manual comparison, and one line, a printed side graphic priced from the market at £95, is two-thirds of the gap.

**Technical Design proved the hard cases.** The Design Vault now handles an administrator cancelling another user's checkout, cross-project and library referencing, WIP-to-Released workflow states with automatic revisioning, and a browser-only check-out and check-in for laptops with no desktop install. The PDM handover meeting of 30 September confirmed that PDM Standard's metadata sits in SQL that SDI may read, which de-risks a later migration either way. A wider decision on how far to take the in-house Vault against PDM Standard is now put to Matt in section 07.

**Client Briefing went in front of Matt and Jonathan.** Matt saw it and gave new directions, one of them **Brief Lite**: a lighter tool for account and project managers that turns a described brief into a full pack, concept visuals and a one-page client sheet, drawn from the SDI work already indexed. Jonathan ran it on real briefs and was happy with the structure. WhatsApp is connected on a test number. Drawing Search has a new requirement from Dave: search by UPC or drawing number on the K: drive as well as W:.

**Sage X3 is loading the estimating tables this week:** BOMs, routes and products, with customers and suppliers beside them, and estimating, customer services, finance and the

warehouse as the first user groups once the first pass is in test. The 30 October target for every area loaded and tested holds.

02 Workstream 1 — SDI Estimating Intelligence

STATUS

OWNER

WITH

Parallel run

J. Gray

James Ryan · Dave's estimators

GO-LIVE

MONDAY 2 NOVEMBER 2026 · WITH THE SERVER

confirmed by testing and the estimators' sign-off, not by the date

A deterministic cost-estimating engine. A drawing pack goes in, and out come a costed workbook on the estimators' own template, a job report, a covering e-mail, a customer quote and the **BOMs and Routes** pair. Every priced line names its source. Since the 29 September report there have been 93 commits and 70 numbered decisions (D-329 to D-398), the register stands at 384 rows, and the suite at 7,731 passing.

THE SEPTEMBER WAVE, COUNTED ON 5 OCTOBER

|                                                                                           |                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>25 packs in the wave ·</div> <div>24 issued, one held back</div>                     | <div>43 packs since May ·</div> <div>every one on the test log</div>            |
| <div>12 reviews back ·</div> <div>Howard, Tim, Dave, Tony</div>                           | <div>6 parity comparisons ·</div> <div>AI against the manual sheet</div>        |
| <div>70 decisions this week · D-329</div> <div>to D-398, each with source and proof</div> | <div>7,731 tests passing</div> <div>· executing the engine</div>                |
| <div>8 packs awaiting review ·</div> <div>plus the M&amp;S re-runs with Dave</div>        | <div>0 of 3 supplier price lists</div> <div>loaded · contacts now in hand</div> |

## What went out since 29 September

| JOB         | WHAT IT IS                                                                                   | WHAT IT TAUGHT THE ENGINE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | POSITION        |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| M&S concept | Clothes recycling unit, re-run from Dave's brief<br>350 off · plywood and mild-steel options | Dave's brief of 30 September was typed into a new <b>Enquiry brief</b> box on the portal and read as stated facts, so a render-only run now prices what the estimator knows, not what the picture suggests. Thirteen rules came out of the three books: a customer named on a run brings its commercial terms, print is always its own line, a lid brings its hinges, a blank that fits no sheet is costed turned.         | WITH DAVE       |
| 12527-22-GA | M&S TSE footwear hero riser<br>72 off · sent 4 Oct to Tim, cc Dave                           | Weld symbols are read off each sheet's own vectors (ISO 2553 and AWS: spot, seam, fillet). A part whose sheet shows only spot welds is spot welded, with arc welding and dressing ruled out on it and its members. Powder time now follows coated area, so a 0.17 m <sup>2</sup> riser no longer carries a line-capacity charge.                                                                                           | AWAITING REVIEW |
| 12173-02-GA | M&S card spinner, prototype<br>1 to 500 off · sent 4 Oct to Tim                              | The first pack with a <b>brief written from the drawings before the first run</b> , scored by a checker: 150 of 155 facts hold on the fifth book. Thirteen rules: a weld needs the part's own evidence and the pack's "ALL WELDS TIG" is how, not that; a stated coat needs something to coat; a drawing's product code is asked of SDI Live before the material word; a section prices from the catalogue's stock length. | AWAITING REVIEW |

| JOB           | WHAT IT IS                                                                      | WHAT IT TAUGHT THE ENGINE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | POSITION        |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 12696-01-GA   | M&S bag pricing hook<br>1 to 2,500 off<br>· sent 5 Oct to Tim and Dave          | Three books in an afternoon against the brief. A weld symbol is read on either line of its callout; a tolerance is not a gauge; a printed line is read whole where the reader had interleaved two; the weld row names the pack's process (TIG) beside the rate it is charged at; and the quantity-break sheet now says <b>what the fall from one off is made of</b> : packaging, delivery and set-up per unit, and the unit cost with the spread money taken off. | AWAITING REVIEW |
| 9439-01-04-GA | Harrods table-standing POS holder<br>1 to 100 off · sent 5 Oct to Tony and Dave | Two books in an hour. One joint on one assembly is one event; a weld note on the sheet ("WELD & DRESS") is the drawing's statement of the weld; a ring's outline is its rim, not its hole; a non-metal sheet with a detail sheet of its own is cut here, never bought; and the job's own numbering names the job at any level, which is what the portal refused on the first attempt.                                                                             | AWAITING REVIEW |

Reviews back since 29 September

Tim, 30 September · 12567-

01 lit header kit NEXT CHANGES

The AI estimate came out **about £240 a unit above his manual figure** at 163 off. The side graphic was priced at £95 each from the market against Motion's £13.19, two per unit, which is about two-thirds of the gap. His other points: the LCD player is supplied by the client and should not be on the drawing; the weld and dress rate is very high, so can the engine allow for spot welding (it now does, from 12527-22); and only a small price is carried for packaging and delivery. Tim also reviewed 12614-01.

Dave, 30 September · M&S

concept and 12645 INTEGRATED

On the render-priced recycling unit: *“a good estimate for a non-SDI drawing pack, and it helps with the overall estimate”*, followed by a brief for the 350-off re-run in plywood and in steel. 12645, the DRS shelter, is deprioritised as a pack and closed without review; the ten rules it produced stay in the engine.

Parity — the go-live KPI

Each job is shown as a variance and a direction. By the pricing policy, no figure from a manual estimate appears in this report. Six comparisons now, with Tim's 12567-01 added.

| JOB · ESTIMATOR   | AT    | VARIANCE        | KEY CAUSE                                                 | ESTIMATOR INTERVENTION                                |
|-------------------|-------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| 7332-01<br>Howard | 6 off | -24.8%<br>under | Plating and the freight to the plater carry no price      | A 12-point review; department times and rates adopted |
| 12349-02<br>Tim   | 7 off | -22.9%<br>under | Packaging, delivery and two fixings unpriced on that book | 14 points; nine confirmed fixed                       |

| JOB · ESTIMATOR           | AT      | VARIANCE                   | KEY CAUSE                                                                                                           | ESTIMATOR INTERVENTION                            |
|---------------------------|---------|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>10975-02</b><br>Howard | 10 off  | +12.9%<br>material +0.4%   | Material essentially exact; one labour line with Howard                                                             | Material agrees to within a penny                 |
| <b>11908-21</b><br>Tony   | 50 off  | about +6%<br>over          | The joinery route was missing and has been added                                                                    | One review                                        |
| <b>1176-02</b><br>Howard  | 10 off  | about +33%<br>over         | <b>One line:</b> the vinyl graphic the customer had already priced. Without it about 17% under                      | One line                                          |
| <b>12567-01</b><br>Tim    | 163 off | about +£240 a unit<br>over | <b>One line:</b> the side graphic, a market figure of £95 each against the supplier's £13.19. Two-thirds of the gap | Four points; spot welding now read from the sheet |

## The same lesson twice: a price somebody already has

On 1176-02 the customer's own vinyl price, and on 12567-01 the supplier's graphic price, each outweighed the whole of the rest of the variance. Nothing in a drawing pack tells the engine those prices exist. Two things follow and both are in section 07 with owners and dates: the **supplier price lists**, for which estimating's contact spreadsheet is now in hand, and **a place on the run page for a quoted price**, so a figure the account manager already holds is entered once and reaches the estimate, the quote and the price history.

## What landed in the engine

### A brief before the first run

NEW · METHOD

For 12173-02, 12696-01 and 9439-01-04 the drawings were read first and the right book written down as facts: the parts, the joints and whether they are symbols or notes, the coats, what is supplied by others, the quantity breaks. A checker scores every book against that file. A book that fails a fact is fixed in the engine and re-run; nothing is edited by hand. On 9439-01-04 a reading error in the DXF of a thin ring was found and fixed *before* the first run.

### A weld needs the part's own evidence

NEW · TIM, DAVE

Weld symbols are read off each sheet's vectors; a note on the sheet is the drawing's statement; a member stated WELDED under a welded assembly is that assembly's joint, charged once; the border legend's "ALL WELDS TO BE TIG" is how a weld is made, not that one exists, and is named on the weld row beside the rate charged. A part with no evidence of its own is asked at £0, not charged. This answers Tim's spot-welding point and Dave's standing rule that nothing is priced on a near match.

### The estimator's brief, typed on the portal

NEW · DAVE

A render-only enquiry now takes a brief in a box on the run page: quantity, materials, sizes, finish, the customer. It is filed with the pack, confirmed by the service, read as stated facts, and a run whose brief was not filed is stopped. The customer named brings its commercial terms.

The break table says what the fall is made of NEW · 12696-01

Under every quantity break the sheet now shows packaging and delivery per unit, labour set-up per unit, run labour, and the unit cost with the spread money taken off, through the unit cell's own arithmetic. An estimator can see at a glance that the fall from one off is set-up and freight dividing, not the work changing.

The portal and the runner DONE

One machine runs one portal and the page warns of a second; a restarted runner releases its job and will not restart mid-job; a job folder's sub-folders are never read; a job's own numbering is accepted as the product at any level; a busy Excel is retried and the refusal note names the real cause.

Run time NEXT

Each run now writes a timing table. The work to read it and re-run only what a change affects starts when the four packs out this week have been reviewed. The server is the other half of the answer, and it is not a substitute for this.

03 Workstream 2 — SDI  
Technical Design Intelligence

| STATUS                                             | OWNER               |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Vault: hard cases proven · P2 UAT waiting          | Y. Kumar            |
| RESOURCE                                           | DECISION POINT      |
| Sole developer                                     | END OF OCTOBER 2026 |
| SDI Design Vault go / no-go · Standard vs in-house |                     |

Two threads. The **Document Manager tools** read SolidWorks project data without a SolidWorks seat and pull the right drawing pack into the estimating app (P1) and the shop-floor Production folder (P2). Then the **SDI Design Vault**, an in-house PDM on GitLab and LFS with an API that the estimating tools, Sage X3, QC and AI can reach.

The week to 2 October, in Yogesh's report

## The Design Vault handles the hard scenarios PROVEN

Not just the core loop. In the week: **an administrator cancelling another user's checkout** for holiday cover, with the lock holder told and blocked from overwriting with a stale copy until they Get Latest; **cross-project and library referencing**, where Check Out lists the assembly and its referenced parts including those in other projects, pulls references read-only without locking, and "save a copy for this project" creates a new file rather than editing the shared source; **workflow states** separate from the lock (WIP and Released, with Revise returning a file to WIP and advancing the revision letter, and Publish Production recording the released revision); and a **browser-only check-out and check-in** by zip download with a small local agent, so laptops need no desktop install. Users and designer/admin roles are in Postgres; Add Files is simplified to customer and project number.

These are the "complex" cases Ian asked to see proven before Phase 3. The deciding feature for the go/no-go, cross-project and library referencing, is now built and is demonstrated next, to be tested on Ian's K-drive dummy projects.

## PDM handover: the migration path is clear 30 SEP

The handover meeting with Ian, Steve, James and Yogesh confirmed that PDM Standard stores its metadata in SQL with the files as an archive on disk, that SQL access is permitted, that PDM and SolidWorks versions must stay matched, and that a handover document follows. Standard has no API, but its SQL can be linked to the archive files, which de-risks a future PDM to Vault migration whichever way the October decision goes.

## The extraction endpoint, hardened on live projects 610 TESTS

Verified against the W: share on 10875, 11676, 12173, 12432 and 12527. A redundant-folder revision bug on 10875-01-GA (stale Rev A to E being pulled instead of Rev G) is fixed by recognising archive markers such as Redundant, superseded and obsolete, configurable. The ambiguous-token response now carries a ranked list of candidates, with an opt-in rule to auto-select a single unrivalled master. 11676-18's missing PDF and STEP were traced to a missing native drawing and an unlinked STEP, and a tightly gated same-folder PDF fallback was shipped. A live-verification script deleted a configuration file, recovered from local history; a safeguard rule is in place.

Requirements from the design working session, 1 October

CAPTURED

- Library get-latest-only with path remapping; "select all, single checkout" (assembly locked, references get-latest); a BOM and linked-file listing at checkout time.
- E-mail and in-tool notifications: checkout cancelled, status changes, change requests.
- Workflow states; the Production Extraction tool embedded as a launch button; a limited QC/ECR login; cross-project referencing.
- **Where AI adds most value:** reference intelligence and cross-reference impact analysis over the Vault's structured data — not CAD generation. SolidWorks' own AI drawing tools were rated poor and unused.

Also in Yogesh's week

DONE

- A false "connection closed" check-in failure fixed, and toolbox-only parts confirmed to resolve once checked in.
- Jira: a company-managed project with a project → phase → task hierarchy and tracked timelines, being configured.
- Direction from the daily meetings: carry on with the Vault's complex functionality, and **begin drawing and assembly/part automation in parallel**, because Brief Lite (section 04) is likely to need it.

The plan, as the 2 October tracker states it

| REF | PHASE                                                          | WHERE IT STANDS                                                                                                    | DATE                           | STATUS                    |
|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------|
| P1  | <b>Design files extraction</b><br>Document<br>Manager API      | Endpoint hardened across five live projects; deployment still not confirmed.                                       | <b>15 Sep 26</b>               | <b>NOT CONFIRMED LIVE</b> |
| P2  | <b>Production Design Extraction</b><br>Document<br>Manager API | Development complete. The feature branch merges to main next week, then a ten-phase review of the repository. User | <b>2 Nov 26</b><br>was end Oct | <b>LIVE WITH SERVER</b>   |

| REF    | PHASE                                             | WHERE IT STANDS                                                                                                                  | DATE           | STATUS          |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|-----------------|
|        |                                                   | testing with Ed and Ian needs the server, so it <b>goes live with the server on 2 November.</b>                                  |                |                 |
| P3.1   | <b>Design Vault — MVP</b><br>In-house, phase 1    | The hard scenarios proven. Designers' testing needs the test server, which is the Linux side of the new machine from 2 November. | 6 Nov 26       | IN PROGRESS     |
| C1, C3 | <b>SolidWorks drawing and ASM/PRT automations</b> | POC done. Now started in parallel for Brief Lite.                                                                                | Was Jan/Feb 27 | BROUGHT FORWARD |
| P3.2   | <b>Design Vault — CAD-aware</b>                   | Where-used and missing references.                                                                                               | 30 Nov 26      | NOT STARTED     |
| P3.3   | <b>Design Vault — engineering revisions</b>       | Approval workflow. Revise and auto-revisioning already exist in the POC.                                                         | 19 Jan 27      | NOT STARTED     |
| P3.4   | <b>Design Vault — release workflows</b>           | WIP, prototype and production release routes.                                                                                    | 1 Feb 27       | NOT STARTED     |

Watch-points

- **The test server.** Yogesh's report has it "still being ordered, 1 to 2 weeks". It is ordered: on site 19 October, the Linux virtual machine built in the week of 19 October, Technical Design's services installed by 29 October. Designers can test from 2 November. The go/no-go at the end of October therefore rests on Yogesh's demonstrations, run in parallel with PDM, and the designers' hands-on testing follows it.
- **A decision for Matt, not the developer.** How far to take the in-house Vault against PDM Standard, given that a two to three month build delivers the core workflow but not every PDM feature. Section 07.
- **One developer, more in parallel.** P2's go-live, the Vault's demonstrations, the ASM/PRT automation for Brief Lite and Jira now run through one person, with leave from 10 December inside the plan.

**Next week:** merge the extraction branch into main and run the ten-phase review; continue the Vault and demonstrate the requested features (cross-project referencing, notifications, select-all checkout); begin ASM/PRT automation; keep Jira current.

04 Workstream 3 — SDI Creative Design Intelligence

| STATUS                                             |                 |                             | OWNER                                    |                               |
|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Search on trial · Briefing in testing · Brief Lite |                 |                             | M. Yazir                                 |                               |
| PROJECTS                                           |                 |                             | NEXT                                     |                               |
| 3 active · 1 paused                                |                 |                             | STUDIO DEMO AND REVIEWS · W/C 12 OCTOBER |                               |
|                                                    |                 |                             | LMC presentation the main focus          |                               |
| SERVICE NAME                                       | TRACKER NAME    | FOR                         | POSITION                                 | BLOCKER                       |
| SDI Drawing Search Intelligence                    | Fixture Library | Design and technical teams  | STUDIO TRIAL RUNNING                     | The server – live on it 2 Nov |
| SDI Client Briefing Intelligence                   | Client Briefing | Jonathan · the studio teams | WORKING, IN TESTING                      | – (WhatsApp on a test number) |

| SERVICE NAME   | TRACKER NAME    | FOR                          | POSITION      | BLOCKER                            |
|----------------|-----------------|------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------|
| Brief Lite     | New · from Matt | Account and project managers | NEW DIRECTION | OpenAI API credits for the visuals |
| Image Upscaler | Image Upscaler  | Sarah, Dean                  | PAUSED AUG 26 | —                                  |

Client Briefing: demonstrated to Matt, tested with Jonathan, on WhatsApp

IN TESTING

- **Demo to Matt.** He liked it and gave new directions, including Brief Lite below.
- **Testing with Jonathan on real briefs.** Most briefs were assigned to the right team, and the correct details were pulled from his e-mails and calendar. He was happy with the overall structure.
- **WhatsApp connected.** Anyone set up on it can ask about any brief by voice note or text — "What's the deadline for the Boots job?", "Who's booked on it?" — and it understands follow-up questions. It runs on a test number for now.

**Status: working and in testing.** Next: show the full web tool to the studio team next week and gather their reviews; test WhatsApp further.

Brief Lite: a lighter tool for account and project managers

NEW · MATT

They describe the client's brief after a meeting, and it produces the full pack, including new concept visuals, so something can go to the client for approval straight away. It finds the closest past SDI work for that client from the jobs, renders and estimates already indexed, so the visuals are based on what SDI has actually built rather than generic AI images. It draws a concept GA at the exact size the client asked for, and puts everything into a one-page client sheet and a full internal brief PDF.

**Blocker:** generating the 3D visuals needs OpenAI API credits, which Muhammad arranges next week. It also needs the SolidWorks assembly and part automation, which is why Yogesh has started that in parallel (section 03).

Drawing Search: the trial runs on, and a new requirement from Dave TRIAL

The design and technical teams' trial is still running, with their feedback expected next week. Dave has raised a new requirement: the team often search by UPC or drawing number on the **K: drive**, and the tool searches the **W: drive** only. **Next:** extend the search to **K:** so that anything there comes up just as quickly. It goes live on the server on 2 November.

KTP reporting DONE

Muhammad has put together the Impact Log, Benefits Log and Risk Register covering the whole year since he joined the KTP. They feed straight into the LMC presentation, which is his main focus next week.

Image Upscaler PAUSED AUG 26 · 56%

Unchanged. Paused on studio priorities, not on any failure; its CMYK conversion stays in daily use.

05 The SDI Intelligence server  
— ordered, live 2 November

One machine for all three workstreams, replacing the estimating laptop as the production machine. Ordered this week from Scan 3XS on a fourteen-day lead time. James Gray leads the software design; Jack Calow, SDI's hardware advisor, builds the machine; the Technical Design team installs its own services.

| ORDER                    | HARDWARE       | ON SITE    |
|--------------------------|----------------|------------|
| 3XS Custom Evolve WRX90E | £10,963 ex VAT | Mon 19 Oct |

LIVE FOR ESTIMATORS AND STUDIO  
MONDAY 2 NOVEMBER 2026  
with a week in hand

What it carries, and how it is set up

The machine runs **Windows Server 2025** on the metal with Hyper-V. Everything people use runs inside one **Windows 11 Pro virtual machine** that owns the graphics card; a

second **Linux virtual machine** carries Technical Design's server side. Jack and James log in from their desks without interrupting an estimate. No third virtual machine.

| WHAT                                                                                                                        | WHERE             | WHY THERE                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Estimating engine and runner, the portal and queue, Excel, SOLIDWORKS, the RTX 4000 Ada                                     | VM 1 · Windows 11 | COM needs a logged-in desktop; the card is here; SOLIDWORKS does not run on Windows Server |
| Client Briefing Intelligence; Drawing Search including the image search                                                     | VM 1 · Windows 11 | Moves as it is; the image search uses the card                                             |
| SOLIDWORKS Document Manager API, CAD Validator, COM tools                                                                   | VM 1 · Windows 11 | SOLIDWORKS libraries, Windows only; exposed to the Linux VM over HTTPS on one port         |
| Document Manager intelligence layer, Production Design Extraction (FastAPI); SDI Design Vault (GitLab with LFS, PostgreSQL) | VM 2 · Linux      | Linux-native; its own large disk; the designers' test server                               |
| Hyper-V, the SolidNetWork licence manager, Remote Desktop for Jack and James                                                | Host              | Two administrator sessions at once; nothing a person uses runs here                        |
| Estimating shares and W:                                                                                                    | The file server   | This machine is not a file server                                                          |

### The one decision still open with the supplier

Windows 11 Pro, the operating system Scan supplies, cannot give a graphics card to a virtual machine. Scan has said the board in the quoted build does not support Windows Server 2025, so the order asks for the same build on a board that does, at the same lead time. If Scan cannot, the quoted workstation is built on **Proxmox**, a Linux hypervisor: the card still passes through to the Windows virtual machine and nothing in the licence table below is spent on Windows Server. What that route gives up is Dassault's formal support statement for the virtual environment. Either way the hardware order stands and the dates hold; day one on the delivered machine is a check with the free evaluation edition, not a meeting.

## The full installed cost — for Matt

Matt asked for the full installed cost with Jack and the increase over the original approval. Indicative, ex VAT, to be confirmed by the suppliers' quotes.

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                                              | EX VAT                        | NOTE                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Hardware</b> , as quoted by Scan 3XS:<br>Threadripper PRO 9975WX (32 cores),<br>ASUS WRX90E-SAGE SE, 128 GB DDR5<br>ECC, RTX 4000 Ada 20 GB, 2 × 2 TB<br>NVMe, 3-year warranty | <b>£10,963</b>                | £13,155.28 inc VAT.<br><b>About £5,963 above the roughly £5,000 workstation approved in September</b> , because it carries three services and the Vault side by side          |
| Windows Server 2025 Standard, two 16-core packs, plus client access licences at about £40 each                                                                                    | <b>about £2,000 + CALs</b>    | <b>Only if Scan supplies a Server-listed board</b> and it installs cleanly; nothing on Proxmox. Bought only after the operating system has installed on the delivered machine |
| Windows 11 Pro licence for the virtual machine                                                                                                                                    | <b>about £200</b>             | The free copy with the workstation licenses the machine itself, not a virtual machine                                                                                         |
| Microsoft Office for the virtual machine                                                                                                                                          | <b>per existing agreement</b> | Excel is what the estimate books run in                                                                                                                                       |
| Linux virtual machine; Proxmox if that route                                                                                                                                      | <b>nothing</b>                | Both are free                                                                                                                                                                 |
| SOLIDWORKS: a possible change of licence if unattended automated use needs one                                                                                                    | <b>unknown until settled</b>  | SDI's own licence agreement is being read this fortnight; the reseller is asked only where it is silent. Any cost comes back to Matt                                          |

| ITEM                              | EX VAT                      | NOTE                                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                   |                             | with the figure before it is committed                                                             |
| <b>Indicative total installed</b> | <b>about £13,200 + CALs</b> | Hardware, Server and Windows 11 licences; before any SOLIDWORKS change, and £2,000 less on Proxmox |

## The build, week by week

| WHEN              | WHAT HAPPENS                                                                                                                                                                                                        | WHO                                        |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| <b>w/c 5 Oct</b>  | Order placed with Scan on a fourteen-day lead time; Scan's answer on a Windows Server board. The SOLIDWORKS licence position read; accounts, fixed IPs, firewall rules, installers and Linux build scripts prepared | Jack Calow · James Gray · Technical Design |
| <b>Mon 19 Oct</b> | Hardware on site. Windows Server 2025 evaluation installed and every device proved driven, or the Proxmox fallback; the Server licence bought only on a clean result                                                | Jack Calow                                 |
| <b>20–23 Oct</b>  | The host, the Windows virtual machine with the card, the Linux virtual machine; domain join, remote access, firewall, backups; handover checks                                                                      | Jack Calow                                 |
| <b>23–29 Oct</b>  | The estimating services, portal, Client Briefing, Drawing Search, the Document Manager tools and SOLIDWORKS installed on the Windows side; GitLab, PostgreSQL and FastAPI on the Linux side                         | James Gray · Technical Design              |
| <b>29–30 Oct</b>  | Proving: known jobs re-run and compared with the laptop; a full restart; the remote in-and-out test during a running job                                                                                            | James Gray                                 |

| WHEN                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | WHAT HAPPENS                                                                                                                                                                                            | WHO                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Mon 2 Nov                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Live for the estimators and the studio; the laptop stood down as the production machine.</b> AI estimating, Production Design<br>Extraction and Drawing Search on it; Design Vault testing can start | All three workstreams |
| <div><div><div><div>Security and configuration actions</div><div>CLOSED IN THE PLAN</div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Remote access: Remote Desktop to the host only, two administrator sessions; the Windows VM reached through the Hyper-V console, or as the runner account alone with a hand-back script; never another user while a job runs.</li><li>• Firewall: the portal, Drawing Search and Client Briefing ports from the office network; the COM tools' port from the Linux VM only; PostgreSQL from the Windows VM only.</li><li>• Backups of the host and both VMs plus GitLab's own, with one restore of each tested before go-live. Mirrored storage asked for in the order.</li><li>• Updates: host and the Windows VM on different nights, James told first; Ubuntu security updates unattended with reboots announced. A UPS, power-on after a cut, both VMs auto-start.</li><li>• Accounts: a service account for the portal and a runner account, on the domain with fixed IPs and names.</li></ul></div><div><div>Still open</div><div>OPEN</div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Scan's answer on a Windows Server board, which decides route 1 or Proxmox.</li><li>• The SOLIDWORKS licence position on activation in a virtual machine and on unattended automated use: SDI's own agreement first, the reseller only where it is silent.</li><li>• Microsoft sign-in with MFA in front of the portal for use from outside the office, which is a go-live gate for remote starting of jobs, not for the office.</li><li>• A second graphics card, only if Technical Design later runs models on the Linux side; the board has the slot and the power lead is asked for.</li></ul></div></div></div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                       |

## What could go wrong, and what is done about it

**Delivery slips:** every later date moves with it and go-live holds in the week of 2 November with a week in hand; Jack has Scan's date in writing. **Windows Server will not install cleanly:** found on day one with the evaluation edition before the licence is bought; Proxmox instead, nothing wasted. **The licence does not permit automated use:** established before SOLIDWORKS automation goes live; the right licence at its price, or another way of reading models. **One estimate at a time:** one runner as today; a second Windows VM with a runner is designed for and not built. **A Windows update mid-estimate:** scheduled out of hours, James told first. **Run time:** the server is faster but does not fix the engine's own minutes; the timing table does, separately.

## 06 Sage X3 data migration

STATUS

OWNER

**Loading estimating this week J. Gray**

WITH

**Acuity · Dave's team · the data owners**

ALL AREAS LOADED AND USER-TESTED

**FRIDAY 30 OCTOBER 2026**

dress rehearsal and cutover in November, to be confirmed

The Access Supply Chain database behind SDI Live moves to **Sage X3**. Loading and user acceptance testing are one cycle, area by area, on real SDI data: each area is loaded into test, tested by its own users, fixed, then kept current by incremental updates.

### This week: the estimating tables, with customers and suppliers

The first-pass test load this week is the **estimating tables — BOMs, routes and products — and customers and suppliers** beside them. Once the estimating data is in test on this first pass, user testing opens to **estimating, customer services, finance and warehouse and manufacturing** in that order, each on its own loaded area. Dave's team uploads sample estimates and runs the standard reports, including how the estimating engine's BOMs and Routes output connects. The engine's output is an estimate's BOM and route in a structured form, which is the shape an X3 upload takes.

THE PLAN OF RECORD, UNCHANGED FROM 29 SEPTEMBER

813 source tables classified

· 21 carry the migration

8 of 13 load templates · every

record with a status and a reason

207 fields mapped · 16 Acuity

templates; 22 waiting on Acuity

Routes template · still asked of Acuity

| WEEK       | WHAT HAPPENS                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| w/c 5 Oct  | <b>Loading the estimating tables</b> (BOMs, routes, products) and customers and suppliers into test; UAT on estimates starts as soon as the first pass is in |
| w/c 12 Oct | Estimating signed off. First incremental update. Customer services and finance begin on customers, suppliers and open items                                  |
| w/c 19 Oct | Manufacturing actuals; stock, open orders, AR and AP, GL balances, with UAT; the warehouse and manufacturing on their areas                                  |
| w/c 26 Oct | Works orders. <b>All areas loaded and user-tested by Friday 30 October</b>                                                                                   |
| November   | Dress rehearsal and cutover, dates to be confirmed                                                                                                           |
| 4 Jan 27   | ERP go-live. From it the estimating engine reads material and supplier prices from X3, with dual-running across the changeover                               |

Still needed from Acuity

The four critical configuration answers (site, company, product category and unit-of-measure codes), the route template and the pre-populate list with templates, the BICX, BISX and GAS templates, work centres as a master load or not, mandatory-field rules, test environment refresh and the cutover method, and the reporting approach that decides which of the 18 custom-field tables matter. The detail of the classification, the data-quality buckets and the field mapping is in issue 4 and is unchanged.

## 07 Matt's four priorities, answered — and what is open

Matt, 30 September: *"Please confirm the agreed actions and dates by Friday, and flag anything needing my decision immediately. Go-live must remain driven by testing and user sign-off."* Each priority below has an owner and a date. Dates marked **proposed** are confirmed with the people named by Friday 9 October.

| PRIORITY         | ACTION                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | OWNER                                 | DATE                                     |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| 1 · Server       | <p><b>Full installed cost with Jack:</b> hardware £10,963 ex VAT; Windows Server about £2,000 plus CALs only on route 1; Windows 11 about £200; Office per agreement; a SOLIDWORKS licence change unknown until settled. <b>Increase over the September approval: about £5,963 ex VAT</b> on the hardware, for confirmation. <b>Order status:</b> placed this week, fourteen-day lead time, on site 19 October, built 19–30 October, <b>live 2 November</b>. <b>Security and configuration:</b> remote access, firewall, backups, updates, accounts and UPS are decided in the build plan; open are Scan's board answer, the SOLIDWORKS licence position and MFA for use from outside the office.</p> | James Gray · Jack Calow               | Cost confirmed now · live 2 Nov          |
| 2 · Testing      | <p><b>James Ryan agrees dates with Dave</b> for the eight outstanding reviews (12552, 12312-01, 12633-10, 12633-00, 12527-22, 12173-02, 12696-01, 9439-01-04) and for the manual comparison sheets that grow the parity KPI, protecting that time alongside the Sage estimating UAT in the same weeks. Tim's and Dave's reviews of 30 September are in hand. <b>Proposed:</b> dates agreed by Friday 9 October; reviews and sheets back by Friday 23 October, so that go-live on 2 November rests on them.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                        | James Ryan · Dave Wright · James Gray | Dates 9 Oct · returns 23 Oct (proposed)  |
| 3 · Pricing gaps | <p><b>Supplier price lists:</b> estimating has given James a spreadsheet of supplier contacts, and estimating and James are reaching out to them this week for a comprehensive digital catalogue or price list of generic items; Purchasing is coordinated through</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | James Gray · James Ryan · Purchasing  | Requests 9 Oct · loads 23 Oct · entry 16 |

| PRIORITY                 | ACTION                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | OWNER                                                  | DATE                                      |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
|                          | James Ryan. The loader is built and tested; each list is loaded as it arrives. <b>Customer-specific quoted prices:</b> a quoted-price entry on the run page, filed with the pack and carried to the estimate, the quote and the price history, so a price the account manager already holds is entered once. <b>Proposed:</b> requests out by 9 October, first lists loaded by 23 October; the quoted-price entry in the engine by 16 October. |                                                        | Oct<br>(proposed)                         |
| 4 ·<br>Delivery<br>focus | <b>Studio feedback:</b> Drawing Search feedback expected next week, with the K: drive search as the first change; Client Briefing shown to the full studio team next week for their reviews. <b>Into use:</b> AI estimating, drawing-pack extraction and Drawing Search go live on the server on 2 November, driven by testing and the estimators' and studio's sign-off, each with its runbook and the portal's guides.                       | James Gray ·<br>Muhammad<br>Yazir ·<br>Yogesh<br>Kumar | Feedback<br>w/c 12 Oct<br>· live 2<br>Nov |

### For Matt's decision

- **The server's cost.** Confirm the increase of about £5,963 ex VAT over the September approval, and approve in principle the Windows Server licence of about £2,000 plus CALs, spent only if Scan supplies a Server-listed board and it installs cleanly.
- **The SOLIDWORKS licence.** Agreement in principle that if unattended automated use carries a cost, it comes back with the figure before anything is committed.
- **The Design Vault's direction.** Yogesh asks how far to take the in-house Vault against PDM Standard, given that a two to three month build delivers the core workflow but not every PDM feature. The go/no-go at the end of October is a company direction; the evidence is the hard-case demonstrations, and the designers' hands-on testing follows on the server.
- **A date for the estimators and the studio:** Monday 2 November.

## Reviews and manual sheets back by 23 October ACT

Eight packs await review and the M&S re-runs are with Dave. Every returned review has become rules, and the parity count grows only with a manual sheet for the same job at the same quantity. This is the evidence that confirms 2 November.

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**Workstream 1.** James Ryan with Dave's team.

## Supplier price lists and the quoted-price entry ACT

Two reviews in a row were decided by a price somebody already had. The contact spreadsheet is in hand and the requests go out this week; the quoted-price entry is the engine's next piece of work.

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**Workstream 1.** James Gray, James Ryan, Purchasing.

## Sage X3: the estimating load ACT

BOMs, routes, products, customers and suppliers into test this week. From Acuity, the four critical configuration answers and the route template.

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**Sage X3.** James Gray with Acuity.

## Scan's answer on the board THIS WEEK

Decides Windows Server or Proxmox on the metal, and whether the £2,000 licence line is spent. The hardware order and the dates do not depend on it.

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**Server.** Jack Calow.

## Brief Lite's credits and automation NEXT WEEK

OpenAI API credits for the concept visuals (Muhammad, next week), and the SolidWorks assembly and part automation that Yogesh has started in parallel.

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**Workstreams 2 and 3.**

**Drawing Search on the K: drive** NEXT

Dave's requirement: search by UPC or drawing number on K: as on W:.

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**Workstream 3.** Muhammad Yazir.

**Run time on large packs** NEXT

Read the timing table and re-run only what a change affects, once this week's packs are reviewed.

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**Workstream 1.**

**Carried, with no change reported** CARRIED

- **The BrightHR client secret has never been rotated.**
- **SDI-APP01** still needs the rotated database password and its build configuration.
- **Two price sources wired to empty tables** (rung 3 of the price chain).
- **Three configured rates with no live source** (board sheet, zinc plating, section stock), awaiting a ruling.
- **The W: drive and the Vault:** syncing W: on released status is a design decision for P3.1.
- **P1 not confirmed live**, its deployment step still not started.

**Closed since 29 September** CLOSED

- **The server: ordered**, with a build plan, a cost table and a go-live date.
- **Operating system and licensing, RAID and backup, UPS and network placement** are decided in the build plan rather than left to the build week.
- **Which machines get a SolidWorks seat:** the server's Windows virtual machine, with the licence manager on the host.
- **A secure connection for the WhatsApp test:** WhatsApp is connected on a test number.
- **P3.1's user-testing dates:** from 2 November, on the server's Linux side.
- **12645** closed as a pack by Dave; its rules stay.
- **Spot welding** (Tim, 30 September): read from the sheet's symbols from 12527-22.

SDI INTELLIGENCE PROGRAMME STATUS · COMBINED REPORT · ISSUE 5 · ISSUED 6 OCTOBER 2026 · SUPERSEDES 29 SEPTEMBER 2026

SOURCES · SDI INTELLIGENCE COMMIT HISTORY 29 SEP – 5 OCT AND CHANGE REGISTER D-329 TO D-398 · SDI INTELLIGENCE ESTIMATING TEST LOG AND TESTING STATUS, 5 OCT · ESTIMATOR REVIEWS FROM TIM WILKES AND DAVE WRIGHT, 30 SEP · YOGESH KUMAR STATUS AND PROJECT PLAN TRACKER 2 OCT · MUHAMMAD YAZIR WEEKLY UPDATE · MATT EVANS 30 SEP · SERVER BUILD PLAN AND SUMMARIES 5 OCT · SAGE X3 PLAN OF 29 SEP AND THIS WEEK'S LOAD

ESTIMATING GO-LIVE · MONDAY 2 NOVEMBER 2026, WITH THE SERVER – CONFIRMED BY TESTING AND SIGN-OFF, NOT BY THE DATE

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